Cuesheet Code Signing Setup

How to acquire and configure the secrets that make installers trusted and enable auto-updates.

These steps are **optional** and can be added at any time. Until you add them, the macOS and Windows installers still work but are **unsigned** — macOS Gatekeeper and Windows SmartScreen show a warning on first launch. Each step below activates automatically the next time the **Release** workflow runs, as soon as its secrets are present.

> **Where every secret goes.** On GitHub, open your repository and navigate to **Settings** ▶ **Secrets and variables** ▶ **Actions** ▶ **New repository secret**. Add each one by the exact name shown in bold below. (Direct link: github.com/kindlyops/cuesheet/settings/secrets/actions.)

1 Updater signing key — do this first

This keypair lets the app verify and install its own updates. It is separate from OS code-signing and is the only piece needed for auto-update to work.

1. Generate a keypair (pick a password, or press enter for none):

   ```
   npx @tauri-apps/cli signer generate -w ~/.tauri/cuesheet.key
   ```
2. Add two secrets:
   - **`TAURI_SIGNING_PRIVATE_KEY`** — the full contents of the file `~/.tauri/cuesheet.key`.
   - **`TAURI_SIGNING_PRIVATE_KEY_PASSWORD`** — the password you chose (leave the secret empty if you picked none).
3. Copy the **public** key the command printed, paste it into `src-tauri/tauri.conf.json` under `plugins.updater.pubkey`, and commit that change.

2 Apple — macOS signing & notarization

Removes the Gatekeeper warning on macOS. Requires a paid **Apple Developer Program** membership ($99/year).

1. In **Xcode** ▶ **Settings** ▶ **Accounts**, or at developer.apple.com, create a **Developer ID Application** certificate.
2. In **Keychain Access**, find that certificate, right-click ▶ **Export**, and save it as a `.p12` file with a password.
3. Turn the `.p12` into base64 text for GitHub:

   ```
   base64 -i cuesheet.p12 | pbcopy
   ```
4. Create an **app-specific password** at appleid.apple.com ▶ **Sign-In and Security** ▶ **App-Specific Passwords**. Find your **Team ID** on the Membership page.
5. Add these secrets:
   - **`APPLE_CERTIFICATE`** — the base64 text from step 3.
   - **`APPLE_CERTIFICATE_PASSWORD`** — the `.p12` password from step 2.
   - **`APPLE_SIGNING_IDENTITY`** — e.g. `Developer ID Application: Your Name (TEAMID)`.
   - **`APPLE_ID`** — your Apple account email.
   - **`APPLE_PASSWORD`** — the app-specific password from step 4.
   - **`APPLE_TEAM_ID`** — your 10-character Team ID.

3 Windows — Authenticode

Removes the SmartScreen warning on Windows. Requires a code-signing certificate from a certificate authority (e.g. DigiCert, Sectigo, SSL.com).

1. Buy an **OV code-signing certificate**. Prefer one delivered as a file you can export. *Note:* EV certificates usually ship on a hardware token that cannot be exported, so they don't work with this file-based CI flow without a cloud-signing service.
2. Export the certificate as a `.pfx` file with a password, then base64-encode it:

   ```
   [Convert]::ToBase64String([IO.File]::ReadAllBytes("cuesheet.pfx")) | Set-Clipboard
   ```
3. Add these secrets:
   - **`WINDOWS_CERTIFICATE`** — the base64 text of the `.pfx`.
   - **`WINDOWS_CERTIFICATE_PASSWORD`** — the `.pfx` password.

Quick reference — all secrets

Secret name	What it holds
`TAURI_SIGNING_PRIVATE_KEY`	Updater private key file contents
`TAURI_SIGNING_PRIVATE_KEY_PASSWORD`	Password for that key (may be empty)
`APPLE_CERTIFICATE`	Base64 of the Developer ID `.p12`
`APPLE_CERTIFICATE_PASSWORD`	Password for the `.p12`
`APPLE_SIGNING_IDENTITY`	`Developer ID Application: Name (TEAMID)`
`APPLE_ID`	Apple account email
`APPLE_PASSWORD`	App-specific password
`APPLE_TEAM_ID`	10-character Apple Team ID
`WINDOWS_CERTIFICATE`	Base64 of the `.pfx`
`WINDOWS_CERTIFICATE_PASSWORD`	Password for the `.pfx`

After adding secrets: re-run the **Release** workflow (Actions ▶ Release ▶ Run workflow). Apple notarization and Windows signing turn on by themselves when their secrets exist; nothing else needs to change. You can add the three groups independently and in any order — though the updater key (step 1) is the one to do first.